

August 12, 2026

BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Department
P.O. Box 100300
Columbia, SC 29202

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Willis Crona (MRN MUSC6939520), Claim MUSC-7099-1

Patient	Willis Crona (DOB 1946-10-19)
MRN	MUSC6939520
Member ID / Group	BCB494161219 / GRP-79505
Claim number	MUSC-7099-1
Date of service	2026-05-05
Procedure billed	CPT 93458 — Left heart catheterization with coronary angiography
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$18,029.32
Denial code	CARC 96 / RARC N130 — Non-covered charge(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-09-01

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal reconsideration request on behalf of Willis Crona (Member ID: BCB494161219, Group: GRP-79505) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-7099-1, dated May 5, 2026, and submitted May 24, 2026. BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina denied the claim in full on June 3, 2026, citing CARC 96 (Non-covered charge(s)) and RARC N130 (Consult plan benefit documents/guidelines for information about restrictions for this service), with the payer remark stating: "Service is excluded under the member's plan benefit document." The total denied amount is \$18,029.32 for CPT 93458 (left heart catheterization with coronary angiography), billed at two units under revenue code 0510. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and requests full reconsideration and payment at the contracted allowed amount of \$9,168.09.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Crona is a 79-year-old male with a documented, active history of atrial fibrillation (onset October 2016), for which he has undergone an extensive course of cardiac intervention. The medical record reflects multiple electrical cardioversions performed between September 2020 and January 2021, as well as three separate catheter ablations of cardiac tissue performed in May 2020, October 2020, and February 2021. He is maintained on Warfarin Sodium, Verapamil Hydrochloride, and Digoxin — a medication regimen consistent with ongoing management of atrial fibrillation and rate or rhythm control. Additionally, Mr. Crona carries active diagnoses of microalbuminuria due to type 2 diabetes mellitus and chronic kidney disease, both with onset in 2001, as well as active neoplasm of the prostate under treatment with Leuprolide Acetate and Docetaxel. This constellation of active, serious conditions establishes a clear clinical context in which cardiac evaluation, including coronary angiography, represents a medically necessary component of his ongoing care. The procedure was performed by Sarah E. Whitmore, MD (NPI 1447382910) at MUSC Health Rutledge Tower Ambulatory Care, an on-campus outpatient hospital facility.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The payer's denial characterizes CPT 93458 as a service excluded under the member's plan benefit document. However, BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina Choice Plus covers Mr. Crona through a plan period extending from January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026, and left heart catheterization with coronary angiography is a well-established, standard-of-care diagnostic procedure for the evaluation of cardiac anatomy and function. Given Mr. Crona's active atrial fibrillation, his history of recurrent cardioversions and catheter ablations, and his comorbid conditions that independently elevate cardiovascular risk, the clinical rationale for this procedure is well-supported by the documented record. A blanket exclusion determination, without reference to the specific clinical circumstances or a medical necessity review, does not constitute an adequate basis for denial. MUSC Health requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina conduct a thorough review of the member's clinical history in conjunction with the applicable plan benefit language to confirm whether a true categorical exclusion applies or whether the denial was issued in error. If the denial is based on a medical necessity determination rather than a categorical exclusion, MUSC Health further requests that the payer clarify the applicable standard and provide the member and provider with a full explanation, as required under applicable appeal-rights obligations.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina overturn the denial of Claim MUSC-7099-1 and process payment for CPT 93458 at the contracted allowed amount of \$9,168.09. Supporting medical records and the remittance advice are attached as required by the My Insurance Manager reconsideration process. Should additional clinical documentation or a peer-to-peer review be required to complete this reconsideration, MUSC Health welcomes that opportunity and asks that the payer contact our Revenue Cycle Appeals team promptly to coordinate, consistent with the appeal deadline of September 1, 2026.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record